

Main

Report Name (Org_Country_Year_Report Type)

IRC Kenya_2022-23_3-month report_(1)

Fellowship Organization

International Rescue Committee (IRC)

Fellowship City**Fellowship Country**

Kenya

Fellowship Start Date**Anticipated Fellowship End Date****What is your fellowship title/role?****What are your primary responsibilities?****I receive adequate direction and support to perform my fellowship responsibilities.**

Neutral

Did you receive any sort of orientation, handover or onboarding when you started your fellowship?

Somewhat

Please describe your orientation/onboarding and note who handled it.

The previous PiAf Fellow created a handover folder and gave me a brief overview over a call, but there were still gaps as the team was quite new and had joined after the Fellow.

If you did not receive any kind of orientation, what information or guidance were you provided at the start of your fellowship?**Describe a representative day at work.****On average, how many hours per week do you work?****How would you describe your effectiveness in your fellowship post so far?**

Effective

Please briefly describe 1-2 specific projects that you have undertaken or accomplishments you have made so far.**What is your organization's work culture like?****What is your office environment like? Please comment on the size and structure of the office(s) where you do most of your work.****To whom do you report?**

The Deputy Director of Grants and Accountability (oversees most of my work)

I also check in with the Regional Head of Communications (oversees regional communications, I would say 25% of my work).

Have you had an initial check-in with your supervisor to set up a work plan and to set goals for your work during your fellowship year?

Yes

Was this meeting helpful in understanding your role and setting goals for your fellowship year?**Please explain why you have not met with your supervisor and if you have plans to do so going forward.****Please briefly indicate 3-5 professional goals you have for the rest of your fellowship year. Your professional goals should align with your work plan.****How often do you check in with your supervisor?**

Weekly

Have you had an opportunity to travel for work so far?

Yes

Describe this travel opportunity. Include location(s) and a brief description of the purpose of the trip(s).**I feel adequately prepared for my position's professional responsibilities.**

Neutral

Please briefly explain your response.

While my position's responsibilities are not difficult and my past jobs have prepared me for adapting to new roles, I think I could have used more training on the Communications role and function - it seems as though it was not clear in the organization in general. I got an overview from the Regional Head of Comms after a month (she had been traveling) but felt a little lost before that. I have had the great pleasure of attending communications trainings with outside instructors, which has been very cool!

Life at Fellowship Site

How did you travel to your host country and site? Please be specific

What kind of visa/ permit do you have or applied for?

How did you obtain (or are obtaining) your visa or permit?

Did you apply for and receive your visa / permit before heading to your host country or after arriving?

What costs were associated with obtaining your visa or permit?

Did you pay the visa / permit costs or were they covered by your organization?

Are you still having challenges obtaining your visa/ permit?

Yes

If yes, please explain further

I was not informed that we would need a special pass which requires a police character reference. This is extremely difficult to obtain while I am abroad. This process also only began after I continuously pursued HR to give more information about the visa process. Even for the single entry visa, I had to follow up multiple times to make sure I had the right information, as if this procedure had never been done before.

g) Do you have any suggestions to help future Fellows navigate the visa / permit application process?

What vaccinations were you required to obtain prior to your departure? How much did your vaccinations cost? Did you get a yellow fever vaccination?

How was your arrival and first week in your host country? Any improvements that could streamline the assimilation process for future Fellows?

Is housing provided by and/or paid for by your organization? Please explain.

Do you live in a location that is more urban or rural?

Very Urban

Please describe your living environment

How do you typically travel between your home and your work? How much does your daily transportation cost and how long is your commute?

If you live in a more rural area, what are the closest urban areas you can travel to for shopping, airport, larger medical centers, etc.?

How is the weather in your host country? What season are you presently in?

What is the appropriate clothing for work and outside of work at your fellowship post and in your community in general?

How have you been spending your free time?

I've been able to successfully navigate my personal/social life both back at home and at my fellowship post.

Strongly Agree

Please briefly explain your response below.

Would you say you live and work in a safe area?

What precautions do you take to ensure your safety?

What has been your experience with crime so far? (Please note that any security or safety concerns or incidents should be reported directly to PiAf staff per PiAf safety and security protocol.)

Describe the incidence of crime and the general security situation within your city/town. Could you recommend specific areas future Fellows might consider for safe housing? What about areas that should be avoided?

Please refer back to the goals you set for yourself before orientation. Are you working towards these goals? Have you met any of them? Changed any of them? Please explain.

Do you have any frustrations with your living arrangements, your work or your life outside of work?

I am very grateful for my living arrangements, since they're comfortable and close to the office. However, there were some moments where I felt my/our personal space was not being respected (i.e. co-workers showing up at the apartment without forewarning and off-schedule for the housekeeper, dishes being used by non-residents and left out, there being a "storage room" for the IRC Somalia office that we were not told about). Some of these issues were directly addressed after my supervisor advocated on our behalf (people showing up randomly and a cockroach issue).

Has there been anything that you have needed but have not been able to locate or acquire?

How have you dealt with "culture shock"?

What about your experience thus far has been the most...surprising?

What about your experience thus far has been the most...challenging?

What are the top 3 things you miss the most from your home country or the U.S.?

What are the top 3 things about life in your host country that beat out life in your home country or the U.S.?

How is your stipend being paid?

How are you receiving your stipend funds?

[Wire](#)

Did you raise funds to cover part of your fellowship expenses?

Please list any additional one-time or infrequent expenses not included in your monthly budget below.

Monthly Budget

Rent	Utilities	Furnishings	Phone	Home Security	Internet
\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
Transportation	Fitness	Entertainment	Groceries	House Cleaning	Eating Out
\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
Medications	Additional Health Insurance	Travel	Laundry	Other	Total Monthly Budget (Minus Entertainment & Travel)
\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	555.00
Specify "Other"					

Final Thoughts

PiAf's orientation was sufficient in preparing me to transition into my fellowship.

Agree

Please briefly explain your response about Orientation.

Is there anything in particular that PiAf could cover at orientation that would have better prepared you for your fellowship post? Please specify.

As we plan the upcoming PiAf Retreat, we hope to incorporate some Fellow suggestions into our programming. What are some topics or sessions you would like to see at the Retreat? (We appreciate your feedback however, we may not be able to accommodate all suggestions or requests this year.)